



The classic version of IPCop 1.4.20, which was released on July 24, 2008, was immediately upgraded to the 1.4.21 ISO installer. The much awaited version 2.0 has been out since September 23, 2011. In this series of articles, we will first take a look at version 1.4.21, followed by the latest release. The basic IPCop distro, combined with various add-ons, builds a fully functional Unified Threat Management (UTM) solution.

Since the beginning, IPCop has been a fantastic firewall distro, with various useful features, including:

- Minimum hardware requirements—even an old 386-based PC with 2 Ethernet cards, 32 MB RAM and a 300 MB hard disk (anybody seen such a configuration lately?)
- Various Internet connectivity options are supported, including ISDN, PPPoE, Static, PPTP, DHCP, etc.
- Basic installation gives excellent firewall functionality, protecting the internal network.
- A very stable distribution.
- Versatile add-ons are available, which extend firewall functionality (see Table 1).
- Uses IPTables to apply rules to received packets.

Table 1: Interesting IPCop add-ons

Add-on	Function
Block Outgoing Traffic	Port-by-port blocking of outgoing traffic
Zerina	OpenVPN server
Advanced Proxy	Advanced proxy
URL Filter	Filtering of unwanted URLs
Calamaris	Proxy report generator
CopFilter	Antivirus and antispam module

Before starting the installation, let us go over the basics of IPCop. The default IPCop installation supports up to 4 Ethernet interfaces, which are colour-coded according to trust levels (Table 2).